

Olimpiu-Vasile Galea

Senior QA Automation Engineer | Cypress Architect

API Testing • CI/CD • Performance Testing

Available for Senior QA Automation, Project based or Consulting roles



📍 Cluj-Napoca, Romania | 📞 (+40) 0765 263 489 | ✉️ oli.galea95@gmail.com | [LinkedIn](#) | [Upwork](#) | Languages: Romanian, English

Senior QA Automation Engineer with 9+ years of experience in software testing, automation architecture, performance testing, and team enablement. Built 20+ Cypress frameworks from scratch and 3000+ automated tests across 20+ applications. Reduced regression cycles from around 3 days of manual testing to under 2 hours. Strong in UI, API, end-to-end, visual, authentication, and database validation, with hands-on work in GitHub Actions, Jenkins, Docker, TestRail, Jira, JMeter, Python, and .NET-based internal testing utilities.

Cypress

JMeter

GitHub Actions

Jenkins

Docker

REST API Testing

DB Testing

UI Testing

Leadership

20+

Cypress frameworks built from scratch

3000+

Automated tests written across products

5+

Projects run in parallel in CI

AI Tools: Daily AI-assisted development using Cursor and modern LLMs (GPT / Claude Opus) to accelerate automation frameworks and debugging.

Profile theme: Quality through efficiency. Strong ownership, practical automation, fast feedback, and scalable frameworks that help teams deliver safer products.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior QA Automation Engineer

Lateral Group · Cluj-Napoca · Jan 2018 – Present

- Created 20+ Cypress automation frameworks from scratch for different types of web applications.
- Built and maintained 3000+ automated tests covering UI, API, end-to-end, authentication, visual, contract, and database validation scenarios.
- Implemented advanced Cypress architecture with custom commands, custom reporters, retries, flaky-test handling, intercept/stubbing, reusable fixtures, test-data generators, environment configuration, CI integration, and parallelization.
- Reduced regression testing from around 3 days of manual work to a maximum 2-hour automated run.
- Structured suites into Acceptance (read-only) and Regression (CRUD) flows to balance speed and depth.
- Integrated automation into Jenkins, GitHub Actions, Dockerized environments, and local execution flows.
- Implemented GitHub Actions matrix runs and supported 5 projects running in parallel.
- Took care of interviews for the company, designed automation interview tasks, reviewed coding exercises, and helped with hiring decisions.
- Created a Cypress Academy inside the company for beginners and mentored 5–10 engineers.
- Managed automation projects across the company and defined testing strategy from scratch for about 90% of projects.
- Learned .NET C# and developed small internal APIs used only for testing.
- Developed ways of working for performance testing with JMeter and created custom JMeter reports.
- Produced training documents and best-practices documentation for QA teams.

QA Automation Engineer — Part-time

NachoNacho · Remote · 2022 – Aug 2023 · via Upwork

- Sole QA on a fintech SaaS platform for virtual cards and banking — no manual tester required; automation-first coverage with Cypress and TypeScript.
- Built hundreds of automated tests focused on integration testing across UI flows and GraphQL APIs.
- Covered critical product flows: sign-up, registration, banking, KYC, payments, and Stripe integration testing.
- Remote part-time engagement alongside full-time role at Lateral Group.

Manual Tester / Software Tester

Lateral Group · Cluj-Napoca · Jan 2018 – Present

- Performed manual regression, acceptance, and exploratory testing for multiple web applications across different client projects.
- Designed and maintained structured test cases and test plans in TestRail while tracking defects and collaborating with developers through Jira.
- Participated in performance and load testing using JMeter to evaluate application stability under heavy traffic conditions.
- Coordinated testing efforts during release cycles and code freeze periods, ensuring features were validated before production deployment.
- Began learning test automation independently outside working hours, experimenting with Cypress to improve testing efficiency.
- Built early automation prototypes and demonstrated their value internally, helping introduce automation testing into client projects.
- These initiatives contributed to automation becoming part of project offerings and client contracts, enabling the transition into a full-time automation engineering role.

Data Entry Team Lead

Lateral Group · Cluj · Jan 2017 – Jan 2018

- Led a remote team of 6–8 data operators, coordinating task distribution and ensuring consistent delivery quality.
- Designed and optimized data processing workflows to improve team efficiency and operational accuracy.
- Developed Python scripts to automate repetitive data handling tasks, reducing manual workload and improving productivity.
- Conducted interviews and onboarding for new team members, helping scale the distributed team.
- Introduced quality control procedures to maintain consistency across large volumes of processed data.
- Worked closely with internal teams to refine operational tools and improve data handling processes.

Data Entry Operator

Lateral Group · Cluj-Napoca · Nov 2017 – Jan 2018

- Performed high-volume data labeling, validation, and editing tasks.
- Began exploring Python and SQL and developed an early interest in process automation — led to transition into software testing.

SKILLS & TOOLS

Automation

Cypress framework · Custom commands · Reporters · Fixtures · Test data generators · Parallelization · Environment configs

Performance & CI/CD

JMeter · Custom HTML reports · GitHub Actions · Jenkins · Docker · Matrix runs · Post-run email

Testing

UI testing · REST & GraphQL API testing · DB testing · End-to-end · Visual testing · Contract validation · Integration testing

Programming & Teamwork

Python · SQL · .NET C# · Jira · TestRail · Team Lead skills · Interviewing

IMPACT SNAPSHOT

Framework architecture at scale

- 20+ frameworks from scratch.
- 3000+ tests across 20+ apps.
- Up to 500 tests per suite, usually organized in 2 suites per project.
- Avoided Page Object Model where it added unnecessary abstraction.

Mentoring and hiring

- Built internal Cypress Academy for beginners.
- Mentored 5–10 QA engineers.
- Designed interview tasks, reviewed coding exercises, and supported hiring decisions.

Test strategy design

- Defined about 90% of project automation strategy from scratch.
- Chose automation scope, suite structure, CI execution, and validation layers.
- Balanced fast acceptance validation with deep CRUD regression coverage.

Performance and reporting

- Worked with JMeter for performance and load testing.
- Created custom performance reports.
- Implemented Mochawesome custom HTML, Allure, TestRail integration, and post-run email reporting.

EDUCATION & REFERENCES

- **Babes-Bolyai University, Faculty of Mathematics and Informatics, Cluj-Napoca** — Mathematics and Informatics · October 2016 – September 2022 · Profile noted in original CV as 2nd year.
- **"Andrei Mureșanu" National College, Dej** — Mathematics-Computer Sciences Advanced · September 2012 – June 2015.

EXTRACURRICULAR ACTIVITIES

Freelance / Besides 9 to 5

- Helps clients build a fast and easy way to make sure their entire application is working.
- Focuses on quick automation setups, including UI loading checks for each page and API validation for each page.
- Offers frameworks that manual testers can use in a reasonable amount of time without needing long-term automation contracts.

Automation Playbook (Architecture & Strategy Guide)

- **Understanding the Target Platform** – analyzing application architecture, services, APIs and dependencies before designing automation.
- **Defining Automation Goals & Scope** – identifying the right level of coverage and avoiding unnecessary automation.
- **Choosing the Automation Framework** – selecting tools and architecture patterns suitable for the project.
- **Test Strategy & Test Types** – balancing UI, API, integration, and acceptance testing layers.
- **Test Case Planning & Design** – designing maintainable tests focused on meaningful validation.
- **Best Practices**
 - Page Object vs Non-Page Object approaches
 - Conditional testing strategies
 - TypeScript vs JavaScript decisions
 - Validating APIs alongside UI flows
 - "Bugs are allowed, same bug twice isn't"
 - Integration testing practices
- **Test Execution Strategy** – suite organization, parallel execution, and CI integration.
- **Reporting & Visibility** – designing reports that provide actionable feedback for teams.
- **Implementation Roadmap** – practical automation adoption plan from Day 1 to Week 10.
- **Using AI to Improve Automation Work**
- **AI as a Productivity Tool (Not a Replacement for Understanding)**

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